



Parental Leave Policy

BluePeak Technologies | Birth, adoption, foster placement, and family bonding

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Document purpose. Paid leave, notice, benefits, job protection, phased return, and coordination rules for birth, adoption, surrogacy, foster placement, and pregnancy loss.

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Quick Answers

Event and eligible employee	Fully paid BluePeak leave
Employee gives birth	16 weeks
Non-birth parent or adoptive parent	8 weeks
Foster placement	4 weeks
Pregnancy loss experienced by employee or spouse/domestic partner	Up to 10 workdays

Administration question	Rule
Service requirement	6 months of continuous service by the leave start date.
Notice	At least 30 calendar days before foreseeable leave; otherwise as soon as practicable.
Use period	Leave must normally be completed within 12 months after birth or placement.
Benefits	Health benefits continue under the same active-employee terms.
PTO and sick accrual	PTO accrues during paid parental leave; sick leave does not accrue.

Administration question	Rule
Phased return	One period of up to 4 weeks at a 60 percent schedule with full base pay.

Key rule: Company parental leave runs concurrently with statutory family, medical, maternity, paternity, adoption, or similar leave to the extent permitted. Concurrent designation does not reduce the BluePeak paid amount; it prevents duplicate leave periods for the same event unless law requires otherwise.

1. Purpose and Inclusive Scope

BluePeak supports time away to recover from childbirth, welcome a child, bond with a new child, complete adoption or foster-placement responsibilities, and respond to pregnancy loss. The policy applies without regard to sex, gender identity, marital status, sexual orientation, or whether the family is formed through birth, adoption, surrogacy, or foster placement.

The policy applies to regular employees scheduled at least 20 hours per week who meet the service requirement. Dublin employees receive the greater applicable company or statutory treatment as coordinated by People Operations and Payroll.

2. Definitions

- 1 Birth parent: an employee who gives birth.
- 1 Non-birth parent: a parent who did not give birth, including a spouse, domestic partner, or intended parent through surrogacy.
- 1 Adoptive parent: an employee who assumes legal placement or custody for adoption, excluding adoption of a spouse's child when no new placement occurs unless law requires leave.
- 1 Foster placement: formal placement of a child with the employee through an authorized agency or authority.
- 1 Child: a person placed with or born to the employee for whom the employee will have a parental role.
- 1 Continuous service: time employed without a break in service, including approved paid leave and legally protected leave.

3. Eligibility

An employee is eligible after completing 6 months of continuous service by the first day of leave. The employee must be active or on an approved protected leave when the qualifying event occurs. A regular part-time employee receives the same number of weeks, paid according to the employee's normal schedule.

An employee who has not completed 6 months should contact People Operations. Statutory leave, disability, Sick Leave, PTO, unpaid leave, or an accommodation may apply. People Operations may approve a company exception for a compelling circumstance, but managers cannot promise one.

When both parents work for BluePeak, each employee has a separate company entitlement based on the employee's role in the event. The company does not require the parents to share a single bank unless applicable law does.

4. Birth Parent Leave

An eligible birth parent receives 16 weeks of fully paid leave. The leave supports medical recovery and bonding; BluePeak does not require the employee to divide the weeks into separate disability and bonding banks for company-pay purposes.

Leave may begin before the expected birth when medically necessary or approved under a statutory leave. Post-birth leave begins no later than the birth date. The 16-week company period includes any short-term disability benefit payable for childbirth; the combined payment will not exceed 100 percent of base pay.

A multiple birth is one qualifying event and does not multiply the 16-week entitlement. A medical complication may support additional disability, protected leave, accommodation, Sick Leave, PTO, or unpaid leave after the paid parental period.

5. Non-Birth and Adoptive Parent Leave

An eligible non-birth or adoptive parent receives 8 weeks of fully paid leave. Adoption leave may begin when the child is placed, when travel is required to complete the placement, or on another date approved by People Operations. Routine pre-placement appointments may be handled with PTO, Sick Leave where applicable, or flexible scheduling.

Surrogacy arrangements are treated according to the employee's parental role. An intended parent who does not give birth receives the non-birth parent entitlement. An employee who gives birth as a gestational carrier receives the birth parent entitlement for medical recovery, regardless of intended parent status.

6. Foster Placement Leave

An eligible employee receives 4 weeks of fully paid leave for a formal foster placement. Leave may be taken continuously or, with approval, in up to two blocks during the first 12 months. Emergency placements do not require advance notice; notify the manager and People Operations as soon as practicable.

7. Pregnancy Loss and Reproductive Events

An employee who experiences miscarriage, stillbirth, or another pregnancy loss, or whose spouse or domestic partner experiences the loss, may receive up to 10 paid workdays. The employee may request additional Sick Leave, Bereavement Leave, PTO, disability leave, accommodation, or unpaid leave based on medical and personal circumstances.

The employee is not required to disclose detailed medical information to the manager. People Operations may request limited confirmation through the confidential process when needed to administer pay or protected leave.

8. Request and Notice Process

Where the need is foreseeable, submit the Leave Request Form at least 30 calendar days before the expected start. Include the estimated event date, requested dates, continuous or intermittent structure, and expected return. The estimate may be updated without penalty when the event date changes.

People Operations provides a written designation, pay schedule, benefit information, required documents, system codes, and return plan. Managers approve coverage and work transition but do not decide medical or legal eligibility.

For an unexpected birth, placement, or medical event, notify the manager and People Operations as soon as practicable. A delayed form does not automatically forfeit leave when circumstances prevented timely submission.

9. Timing and Leave Structure

Paid parental leave must normally be completed within 12 months after the birth or placement. Birth parent leave is ordinarily continuous to support recovery and bonding. Non-birth, adoptive, and foster leave may be divided into no more than two blocks with manager and People Operations approval, unless law permits a different structure.

Company holidays occurring during continuous parental leave do not extend the leave. An employee is not expected to perform work, attend routine meetings, or monitor messages during a full leave block.

10. Pay During Leave

Paid parental leave replaces 100 percent of the employee's base salary or regular scheduled hourly pay, subject to normal deductions. It excludes overtime, commissions, bonus, shift premium, allowances, and other variable pay unless the governing plan states otherwise.

Sales commissions and performance bonuses are handled under their written plans. An employee will not lose an earned payment solely because it is paid during leave, but performance and active-service conditions may affect unearned or future incentives.

Disability or government benefits are coordinated so total pay does not exceed 100 percent of base pay. Employees must provide information needed for coordination.

11. Benefits and Accrual During Leave

Medical, dental, vision, life, and disability coverage continue under the same active-employee contribution rules during paid parental leave. Employee contributions continue through payroll deduction. If a deduction cannot be taken, Benefits will arrange repayment.

PTO continues to accrue during paid parental leave. Sick leave does not accrue during the parental-leave period. Retirement contributions and employer match are based on pay actually processed and plan terms.

Birth, adoption, and placement are qualifying life events. Benefit-election changes must be submitted within 30 calendar days of the event through the Benefits Portal.

12. Phased Return

An employee may use one phased return of up to 4 weeks immediately after parental leave. The standard schedule is 60 percent of the employee's regular schedule with 100 percent of base pay. The employee and manager agree on workdays, hours, priorities, meetings, and handoff. People Operations documents the arrangement.

The phased return is not additional leave and cannot be saved for later. A different temporary schedule may be considered as a disability, lactation, religious, or other accommodation.

13. Lactation and Related Support

BluePeak provides reasonable break time and a private space other than a bathroom for expressing breast milk, as required by law and company standard. Employees should contact Workplace or People Operations to arrange access at a site. Remote employees may discuss schedule needs with the manager without providing medical details.

14. Job Protection and Return

BluePeak will return an employee to the same or an equivalent position, pay, benefits, and work location to the extent required by law and this policy. Legitimate business changes that would have occurred regardless of leave may still apply. Retaliation for requesting or taking leave is prohibited.

Employees should confirm the return date at least 10 calendar days in advance. Medical clearance may be required for a birth parent when the provider imposed restrictions or when the absence meets the Sick Leave return-to-work threshold. Restrictions are reviewed through the accommodation process.

15. Coordination With Other Time Off

BluePeak parental pay is used before optional PTO unless the employee requests otherwise and the arrangement is lawful. Sick Leave may be used for qualifying medical needs before or after parental leave. Bereavement Leave may apply to pregnancy loss or the death of a child. A personal unpaid leave may be considered after protected and paid entitlements are exhausted.

16. Frequently Asked Questions

16.1 Do my health benefits stop while I am out?

No. They continue under the same active-employee terms during paid parental leave.

16.2 Can I take the 8 weeks one day at a time?

Normally no. Non-birth and adoptive leave may be split into up to two blocks; a different intermittent structure may be available under law or an approved accommodation.

16.3 Can both BluePeak parents take leave at the same time?

Yes, subject to each employee's eligibility and reasonable notice. Managers should plan coverage but may not require the parents to alternate unless a legal rule applies.

16.4 Does PTO keep accruing?

Yes, during paid parental leave. Sick leave does not accrue during the parental period.

16.5 What happens if I am not eligible at six months?

Contact People Operations. Statutory leave, disability, PTO, Sick Leave, an accommodation, or unpaid leave may apply.

90. Administration, Exceptions, and Questions

BluePeak administers Parental Leave consistently with the employee's work location, employment classification, written employment terms, and applicable law. A statutory or contractual entitlement that is more generous than this document will apply to the extent required. A manager may not waive a legal requirement, create a new benefit, or promise an exception without written approval from the document owner.

Employees should raise questions before relying on an informal interpretation. Contact people@bluepeaktech.com through Outlook or the People Help channel in Microsoft Teams. Payroll, Legal, Information Security, or a site leader will be consulted when the question involves tax, wage-and-hour, privacy, immigration, safety, or local-law considerations.

Approved exceptions must identify the employee, the policy provision, the business reason, the approving authority, the start and end date, and any conditions. Exceptions are stored with the employee or transaction record and do not establish a precedent for other employees.

91. Related Documents and Systems

Resource	When to use it
Leave Request Form	Request parental leave, planned dates, block structure, and phased return.
Benefits Enrollment Form	Enroll a new dependent when Benefits directs use of the form.
Health Insurance Guide	Qualifying life event, dependent eligibility, coverage, and enrollment timing.
Life & Disability Insurance	Childbirth disability coordination and benefit claims.
Bereavement Leave Policy	Pregnancy loss, death of a child, and compassionate support.

Revision History

Version	Effective date	Change summary
v2.0	2026-08-01	Expanded inclusive definitions, pregnancy-loss support, phased-return administration, and leave coordination.